

Streamer UNTIL

The scariest monster in this society is attention, because the player, the viewer, and the monster all seek it.

firststef / narrative design

01 Theme:

I believe that being a streamer is scary because your only choice is to follow what your viewers want you to do, sometimes at your expense.

I believe that the scariest monster in this society is ATTENTION, because both the player, the viewer, and the monster seek it.

Pillars of fantasy

- Being a streamer in a haunted place
- Feeling doubt that something weird and mysterious is happening in the building
- Feeling the pressure to always keep delivering entertainment to gain sustenance

Plot:

1. He was exploring a hidden building because he needed views for money.
2. The player was dared to do various shenanigans by his viewer because he was exploring the building.
3. Because he was messing around with stuff in the building, he got the attention of the monster.
4. Because he got the attention of the monster, he had to hide or run.
5. Because he was hiding and running, his viewers threatened him to keep entertaining them, or they would cut his funding.
6. Because they threatened the player, the player had to go out of hiding and engage with the monster, even though he was afraid.

Core loop:

1. Action: Chat displays dares that you're required to do. You choose either to do them, and suffer the consequences, or not to do them, and your viewership falls. When it

reaches 0, you die.

2. Reward: You get views and superchats for doing the dares.
3. Upgrade: unlocking new areas to explore
4. Repeat.

02 Worldbuilding:

The game is taking place in an abandoned site outside of a modern city in the current day (2020s). The "game start" is the present day (implied by the streamer persona), while the historical "Incident" is dated to **July 2007**.

The player descends through a **1950s-era reinforced bunker**, into a **1990s-era "Deep Lab,"** and finally reaches a **Deep Excavation Site** at the bottom of a massive vertical shaft

The main character is poor and needs to make a living out of streaming himself into decrepit places.

The game explores themes of **being overlooked, the hollow nature of social media attention, and isolation**

The places have been abandoned, and they were once used for something, and every place has a particular history, one you might uncover if you search long enough for something to decipher.

The world operates on the physics of **electromagnetic resonance**. A corporation called **NarcusTech** (founded in 1976) discovered an anomaly beneath the theater that violated quantum principles. This anomaly is the **Artifact**: a black alien monolith that feeds on attention and consumes electromagnetic signals.

The Streamer (Player): Driven by a need for views and money; their life depends on the "sustenance" of the audience.

The Viewers/Chat: A relentless entity that provides funding but demands dangerous "shenanigans" in return.

Dr. Mira Talon: A brilliant, obsessive scientist whose logs reveal her descent into a mind-corrupted fascination with the monolith.

Security Chief Jin Yohachi: A practical skeptic focused on containment rather than understanding.

The Entity: A violent force released from the monolith during a failed gamma-ray experiment in 2007.

While the world looks like ours, it contains an **eldritch, attention-eating artifact** that treats human viewership as a literal energy source, capable of warping reality and corrupting minds.

Environment for Theme and Plot

- **The Surface/Bunker:** Dark, rusty, and claustrophobic to build the initial "thrill" of urban exploration.
- **The Deep Lab:** Sterile and white, shifting the mood to clinical dread.
- **The Excavation Site:** An impossibly large, alien space that emphasizes the player's insignificance once the monolith consumes their "views".

Rules of the Setting Setting is defined by **how the world reacts to the player**.

- **The Rule of Sustenance:** The player's survival is tied to a "Viewership" meter. If viewership hits zero, the player "dies" because they have lost their reason to exist in this space.
- **The Attention Lure:** The "Entity" is attracted to electromagnetic signals. Because the player is broadcasting, they are **inherently visible** to the monster. The more "hype" the streamer generates, the more aggressive the Entity becomes.
- **The Eskhato-Protocol:** The facility is rigged with explosives designed to seal the lower levels—a rule that ensures the player is trapped once they descend.

Emotional Evocation of Elements

- **Scratch Marks on Hatches:** Evokes the primal fear of being trapped and the realization that others have failed to escape.
- **Keypads and Dead Generators:** Create "pacing" and tension, forcing the player to linger in dangerous areas to regain the "connection" (reception) their audience demands.
- **The Black Monolith:** Initially evokes wonder and curiosity, but eventually represents **pure isolation**, as it consumes the very attention the player worked so hard to gain.

Turning World Elements into a Setting

In this game, the "world" (the bunker and the monster) becomes a "setting" through the **Chat Dares**. The environment doesn't just sit there; it is a stage for the viewers. When the chat displays a dare, the environment reacts to the player's choice. If the player engages with a dangerous artifact to please the chat, the **Entity reacts to that spike in activity**, turning a static room into a dynamic trap.

03 Characters:

1. Drivers (Plot Movers)

- **"UNTIL" The Streamer (Player Avatar/Protagonist):** An urban explorer who descends into an abandoned NarcusTech bunker to livestream for an audience.
- **Role in Game & Story:** The anchor of the core loop. The player navigates the bunker, interacts with the environment, and performs dares to keep the "sustenance" (viewership) meter from hitting zero.
- **Goal:** To gain viewers, survive the underground exploration, and maintain their livestream at all costs.
- **Motivation:** Deep-seated childhood trauma. Coming from a broken home where they were constantly overlooked by their divorced parents, they are desperate for attention and validation to prove they exist and matter.
- **Ethos:** Reckless and dependent. They prioritize the demands of anonymous strangers over their own physical safety, treating attention as a literal lifeline.
- **The Entity / The Monolith (Antagonist):** A violent, eldritch force released from a black alien artifact during a failed 2007 gamma-ray experiment.
- **Role in Game & Story:** The primary physical threat. It actively hunts the player. It turns the static environment into a dynamic trap by reacting to the electromagnetic signals and "hype" generated by the player's stream.
- **Goal:** To feed on electromagnetic signals and human attention, eventually consuming the player into an impossibly large, lonely void.
- **Motivation:** It has no human malice; it is an eldritch anomaly that simply hungers for attention and resonance as sustenance.
- **Ethos:** Relentless, violent, and unknowable. It corrupts minds into believing it has a grand purpose, masking its true nature as a parasitic void.
- **The Chat / Viewers (Contagonist):** The anonymous swarm watching the livestream.
- **Role in Game & Story:** They drive the core loop's tension. They issue "Chat Dares" and control the Viewership meter. If the player disobeys or plays too safely, they leave, effectively killing the player.
- **Goal:** To be entertained by dangerous "shenanigans."
- **Motivation:** Boredom, morbid curiosity, and the lack of empathy provided by internet anonymity.
- **Ethos:** Fickle, demanding, and cruel. They represent the hollow, toxic nature of social media attention.

2. Passengers (Supporters & Allies)

(Note: In this isolated horror setting, passengers exist either purely through text logs or as emotional anchors outside the bunker).

- **Dr. Mira Talon (Guardian/Reason - Posthumous):** The Lead Scientist of Project Eidolon.
- **Role in Game:** Her scattered logs serve as the player's guide, explaining the lore of the monolith, the danger of turning on the generators, and the nature of the entity.
- **Goal:** Initially to understand the artifact's purpose; later, to trap the entity back inside it using the Eskhato-Protocol.
- **Motivation:** Brilliant scientific obsession that slowly morphed into a mind-corrupted fascination, and finally, desperate survival.
- **Ethos:** Rational and controlled at first, eventually giving way to paranoid obsession.
- **The Sister (Emotion):** The streamer's sibling, who shared their trauma of hiding in the basement from their fighting parents.
- **Role in Game:** She grounds the narrative. She is the only source of genuine, unconditional care, contrasting with the toxic Chat. She delivers the final, tragic text message at the end of the game.
- **Goal:** Wants her sibling to be safe and happy.
- **Motivation:** Shared childhood trauma and familial love.
- **Ethos:** Caring, genuine, and grounded.

3. Episodic Characters (The NarcusTech Staff)

These characters appear through environmental storytelling and audio/text logs in specific layers of the bunker.

- **Security Chief Jin Yohachi:**
- **Role in Game:** His logs build early tension. He is the voice of skepticism, noticing the staff going crazy before the scientists admit it.
- **Robin Beaulne:**
- **Role in Game:** The brash Electrical Engineer who goes insane. His logs reveal the horrifying truth (that the artifact feeds on attention and will end the world) but no one believes him. He shows the extreme end of the monolith's corruption.
- **Tracy Yost (Psychologist) & Odd Steensen (Material Scientist):**
- **Role in Game:** Their logs document the physical and mental toll of the monolith (headaches, bleeding noses, aggression), warning the player of the area's passive dangers.

- **Mathilde Renaud (Corporate Overview):**
- **Role in Game:** Represents the cold greed of NarcusTech. Her logs detail the refusal to evacuate and the firing of dissenting staff, enforcing the theme of exploitation.

4. Extras

- **Sofia Haneke (IT Admin):** A small side character whose logs subtly hint at the connection between livestreams and the entity's behavior early on.

Character Spec Document: "UNTIL" (The Streamer)

Overview

"UNTIL" is the player's avatar. They are an overlooked, traumatized individual who has turned to urban exploration livestreaming as a desperate bid for the attention they never received at home.

- **Goal:** Gain viewers and survive the exploration.
- **Motivation:** Desperate need for validation and to not be "overlooked."
- **Ethos:** Reckless dependency on audience approval.

Their character arc is a tragic descent: seeking comfort in an underground space (reminiscent of hiding in their childhood basement), only to realize the attention they sought is exactly what dooms them.

For the Art Team (Visuals & Animation)

- **Base Design:** We only see them in reflections or through the game's UI, but they are dressed in practical, slightly worn modern Urbex gear (hoodie, practical boots, headlamp). Their most important visual feature is the **Camera/Phone Rig**, which occupies the player's First-Person view.
- **Progression Design:** The character's state degrades visually through the camera. The screen gets cracked, battery icons flash red, and if there are reflections, the streamer looks increasingly dirty, terrified, and exhausted.
- **Animations:**
- **Movement:** First-person view-bobbing should feel hesitant when sneaking, and chaotic/shaky when running from the Entity.
- **Interactions:** Hands reaching out to open rusty hatches, type on 1990s keypads, or hesitantly touch the black monolith.
- **Idle:** Nervous fidgeting with the camera gear, wiping the lens, or checking the Chat feed obsessively.

For the Production Team (Tasks & Scope)

- **Priority:** Highest. The player's entire perspective and UI is tied to this character.
- **Assets Required:** * 1st Person rigged arms with a flashlight and smartphone/camera gimbal.
- **UI Overlay:** A highly detailed Livestream HUD (Viewership counter, superchat popups, chat scrolling box, battery life).
- Audio assets: Heavy breathing, panicked muttering, and vocal reactions to Chat dares.

For the Game Design Team (Usage & Mechanics)

- **Core Loop Role:** The player avatar. They must navigate the surface, the 1950s bunker, and the 1990s Deep Lab.
- **The Sustenance Mechanic:** The character is bound to the Viewership meter. Doing safe, boring things drains it. Doing Dares (making noise, touching strange artifacts, turning on power) increases it but attracts the Entity.
- **Tension Anchor:** The character embodies the conflict between the instinct to hide (survival) and the necessity to be seen (sustenance/attention).

For the Development Team (Code & Implementation)

- **First Person Controller:** Implement a standard horror FPS controller with crouch/sneak mechanics and a sprint function dictated by stamina.
- **Livestream UI Logic:** Build a dynamic UI system where the "Chat" acts as an AI director. The chat must push prompts ("TURN ON THE GENERATOR," "GO DOWN THE HOLE") and evaluate if the player is in an "exciting" state (near danger) to calculate the Viewership meter math.
- **Fail States:** 1. Being caught by the Entity (Physical Death). 2. Viewership reaching 0 (Social Death / Game Over).

04 Narrative sequence:

1. Keep working on your game (adding and polishing all the elements you need)
2. Decide on your narrative structure and strategy (how do you want to tell a story and how do you connect it to the gameplay)

Narrative x Gameplay Specification: "UNTIL"

1. Plot & Narrative Structure Overview

Structure Type: Escalating Descent (A vertical adaptation of the Traditional 5-Point Structure). The narrative is strictly tied to the physical descent into the facility. As the player goes deeper physically, the narrative tension (the demands of the Chat vs. the

threat of the Entity) escalates. The core loop of "Receive Dare -> Risk Danger -> Gain Views" loops continuously within each sequence.

Sequence Breakdown & Episode Goals

Sequence 1: Prologue (1 Episode)

- **Episode 1: "Going Live" (Surface/Entrance)**
- *Goal:* Establish the streamer persona, the "Sustenance" mechanic (Viewership meter), and the initial motivation (needs money/attention).
- *Gameplay:* Tutorial for movement and the Chat interface. No monster threat yet.

Sequence 2: Introduction (2 Episodes)

- **Episode 2: "The Rusty Hatch" (Upper 1950s Bunker)**
- *Goal:* Introduce the "Chat Dares" and the passive environmental dread. Establish that the audience is in control.
- *Gameplay:* Player must complete mundane but creepy dares (e.g., "Go into the dark room," "Turn off your flashlight for 10 seconds") to keep the Viewership meter up.
- **Episode 3: "Echoes of NarcusTech" (Lower 1950s Bunker)**
- *Goal:* Introduce the worldbuilding lore via Security Chief Jin Yohachi's logs. Tease the presence of something else in the bunker.
- *Gameplay:* The environment becomes subtly hostile. Noises react to the player's stream volume.

Sequence 3: Rising Action / Exposition (3 Episodes)

- **Episode 4: "The Deep Lab" (1990s Deep Lab Entrance)**
- *Goal:* Introduce the true threat. The Entity is awakened by the electromagnetic signals of the stream.
- *Gameplay:* First physical encounter/chase with the Entity. The player learns the core conflict: hiding drains Viewership, running/screaming increases it but attracts the Entity.
- **Episode 5: "Dr. Talon's Descent" (Lab Quarters)**
- *Goal:* Deliver the core lore regarding the Artifact/Monolith and how it feeds on attention.
- *Gameplay:* Heavy puzzle-solving while avoiding the Entity. Chat dares become actively malicious (e.g., "Smash that glass tube," "Yell her name").
- **Episode 6: "The Ultimatum" (Lab Exit / Shaft Entrance)**

- *Goal:* Push the player to the breaking point. The Eskhato-Protocol is triggered, trapping the player.
- *Gameplay:* Viewership drops rapidly unless extreme risks are taken. The Chat threatens to leave and cut funding if the player doesn't descend into the massive vertical shaft.

Sequence 4: Climax (2 Episodes)

- **Episode 7: "The Black Monolith" (Deep Excavation Site)**
- *Goal:* Confront the source of the anomaly. The player is forced out of hiding by the Chat to engage directly with the Monolith.
- *Gameplay:* High-stakes stealth and chase sequence in a massive, alien space. The Viewership meter is maxed out, making the Entity hyper-aggressive.
- **Episode 8: "Sustenance" (The Core)**
- *Goal:* The narrative peak. The realization that the Chat and the Entity are parallel monsters feeding on the player's attention.
- *Gameplay:* The final dare. The player must sacrifice themselves to the anomaly to satisfy the stream.

Sequence 5: Aftermath (1 Episode)

- **Episode 9: "Connection Lost" (The Void/End Screen)**
- *Goal:* Deliver the thematic punchline. The player is gone, the Chat is satisfied but quickly gets bored, and the Sister's text message grounds the tragedy.
- *Gameplay:* Interactive epilogue. The player can only look at the Chat scrolling over a dropped camera feed until the battery dies.

2. Narrative x Gameplay Implementation Strategy

(For the Game Design & Development Teams)

The Core Loop vs. The Narrative Flow

The story is not pushed forward by cutscenes; it is pushed forward by **The Sustenance Mechanic**.

The Tension Engine:

1. **Safety = Social Death:** If the player hides from the narrative (stays in a safe room, ignores lore, avoids scares), the Chat gets bored. Viewership drops to 0. *Game Over*.
2. **Progression = Physical Danger:** To progress the story and satisfy the Chat, the player must explore, read logs aloud, and perform Chat Dares. This generates "Hype" (electromagnetic signals), which draws the Entity.

System Diagram: The "Attention" Economy

[PLAYER ACTION] ---> (Hides/Plays Safe) ---> [CHAT BOREDOM] ---> Viewership Drops ---> (SOCIAL DEATH)

|

v

(Performs Dare/Explores)

|

v

[HYPE GENERATED] ---> Viewership Increases ---> (SURVIVAL/FUNDS)

|

v

[ENTITY ALERTED] ---> Entity Aggression Increases ---> (PHYSICAL DEATH RISK)

Developer Guidelines for Implementation:

1. The Chat AI Director (The "Contagonist"):

- **Logic:** The Chat system needs to evaluate the player's current state. If the player hasn't moved between zones or encountered a scare in X seconds, the Chat issues a "Dare" (e.g., "Look behind you," "Make a loud noise").
- **Narrative Tie-in:** The Chat text should reflect the lore. Early on, they are just edgy teens. By the Deep Lab, their dialogue should subtly mirror the Entity's hunger, treating the player as a literal battery.

2. Environmental Storytelling & Pacing:

- **Designers:** Place lore (Dr. Talon's logs) in areas that force the player to stand still in the open.
- **Mechanic:** Make the player physically hold up their camera to "scan" or "read" the documents to the Chat. This freezes their weapon/item hands, increasing vulnerability and maximizing the horror of being a streamer.

3. The Rule of Irreversibility (The Eskhato-Protocol):

- **Level Design:** The descent must be one-way. Dropping down shafts, doors locking behind them. This reinforces the theme of "doing anything for views" until there is literally no way back.

4. Entity Aggression Scaling:

- **Devs:** Tie the Entity's aggro radius directly to the Viewership meter integer.
- *Low Views (0-100):* Entity wanders, relies on sight.
- *High Views (10k+):* Entity knows the player's general vicinity and moves faster. The "clout" is literally killing them.

05 Technical writing:

Portfolio Piece 3: UNTIL — Horror Livestream Survival Game

- **Context:** *UNTIL* is a first-person horror game (5 sequences / 9 episodes) about a livestreaming urban explorer trapped in a bunker.
- **Problem:** A live chat UI was a hard design requirement. The chat needed to function as a central, tension-driving mechanic rather than a UI gimmick, making the audience as dangerous as the monster.
- **Role:** Sole Narrative Designer. Owned theme, plot, world rules, the "Attention Economy" system design, and the narrative×gameplay spec.
- **Decision:** Designed a dual-threat "Sustenance Mechanic." The Viewership meter acts as a lifeline (0 views = social death) raised only by performing dangerous Chat Dares. However, high viewership directly scales the monster's aggro radius (high views = physical death). Wrote dynamic Chat dialogue that evolves across sequences to mirror the monster's hunger.
- **Outcome:** Designed a dual-threat attention economy where the livestream chat functions as both lifeline and kill condition, making the horror theme of toxic attention fully playable.

Created system as a contact point between story and gameplay. Added dialogue lines that directed players towards a certain story aspect.